

Lodging Checklist

Everything we need, by job type — check it before you send.



Nearly every job that comes back to us is missing one item from this page. None of it is unusual — it is simply what has to be in front of us before an assessment can be finished.

EVERY JOB, WHATEVER THE WORK

Site Plan

- ☐ Every lot boundary dimensioned
- ☐ The proposed structure dimensioned and located
- ☐ Setback to every boundary — not just the close ones
- ☐ All existing structures on the lot
- ☐ North point and street frontage
- ☐ Easements, sewer and drainage where they affect the works
- ☐ Scale, or a note that it isn't to scale

Elevations

- ☐ Every elevation showing the works — usually all four if freestanding
- ☐ Overall height from natural ground level, not the slab
- ☐ Wall height, or clearance under the beam
- ☐ Roof pitch or fall stated as a figure
- ☐ Post and column positions dimensioned
- ☐ Natural ground line and finished floor level

Engineering

- ☐ Signed and dated
- ☐ Engineer's name, company and registration number
- ☐ Wind region and terrain category
- ☐ Footing details — depth, diameter, reinforcement
- ☐ Tie-down and bracing
- ☐ Matched to this structure and address
- ☐ Any conditions the engineer has set, shown on the drawings too

A plan with too much on it has never delayed a job. A plan missing one dimension routinely does.

THEN, DEPENDING ON THE WORK

Patio, Pergola or Verandah

- ☐ How it attaches to the dwelling — the fixing detail or a reference to it
- ☐ Gutter and downpipe positions, and where stormwater discharges
- ☐ Roof sheet profile and colour
- ☐ Where it sits within 900 mm of a boundary, the fire separation detail

Shed, Garage or Workshop

- ☐ Manufacturer's engineering matched to the wind region
- ☐ Slab detail, or the footing design if no slab
- ☐ Door and opening sizes
- ☐ Wall and roof cladding, and colour
- ☐ If it's to be habitable in any way, say so — it changes the class

Carport

- ☐ Open on the required sides — show which
- ☐ Setback to the street boundary
- ☐ Fixing detail where attached to the dwelling

Retaining Wall

- ☐ Structural engineering design for the wall
- ☐ Existing and proposed levels on both sides
- ☐ Retained height measured from the top of the footing
- ☐ Surcharge where a driveway, structure or fill sits above
- ☐ Drainage behind the wall, and where it discharges
- ☐ Setback from the boundary, and how a boundary wall is dealt with

THEN, DEPENDING ON THE WORK — CONTINUED

Bushfire Prone Lot

- ☐ The BAL assessment itself, not the rating quoted in an email
- ☐ Prepared by an accredited person, dated, for this lot
- ☐ Where BAL-40 or BAL-FZ, construction details on the plans to match

Swimming Pool or Spa

- ☐ Barrier location and type shown on the site plan
- ☐ Gate positions and swing direction
- ☐ Climbable zones on both sides of the barrier
- ☐ Where a boundary fence forms part of the barrier, its height and construction

BEFORE YOU PRESS SEND

Does everything match?	Site plan, elevations and engineering should describe the same structure. Mismatched spans, heights or post spacings between drawings and engineering are the most common reason we come back.
Is the engineering current?	Dated before the design it certifies, or covering a different span or height, and we can't use it.
Are conditions reflected?	A minimum footing depth or maximum span set by the engineer has to appear on the drawings as well. We check one against the other.
Is it legible?	PDFs, right way up, text selectable where possible. A photograph of a drawing on a desk is rarely readable enough to assess.

Not sure whether something applies? Ask before you lodge rather than after. It takes a moment at our end and saves you a request for further information — and the days that go with it.